TEAMCOOK · Methodology guide

TEAMCOOK GAME · METHODOLOGY GUIDE

Methodology guide to the *Team Process Report.*

What it measures, how it measures it, and how to read it. For facilitators with an active license and for the people who receive the report.



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01 THE CORE IDEA

10-MINUTE PATH

Counting *vs. interpreting.*

The Team Process Report analyzes how a group talked while cooperating under pressure. To do that, it separates two things that often get mixed up: what can be **counted** and what requires **interpretation**.

	LAYER 1 · WHAT GETS COUNTED	LAYER 2 · WHAT GETS INTERPRETED
Question	How much and how did each person take part in the conversation?	Which team processes did each person contribute to, and how much?
How it's obtained	By counting speech acts with fixed rules.	By identifying specific statements and placing them on a scale with reference examples.
Room for judgment	None.	Limited: minimum evidence, required quotes, and only five possible levels.
Example	"Ana had 34 speaking turns, 21% of the total."	"Ana made a strong contribution to team coordination (level 4)."

AN ANALOGY: THE STAT SHEET FROM A BASKETBALL GAME

Some stats get counted and nobody argues with them: points, assists, rebounds, minutes on the court. That's Layer 1. Then there's a read on how each player played —who ran the offense, who made everyone else better— done by an analyst using judgment, backed by those stats and by plays they can show. That's Layer 2. The difference: here, the read follows written rules, and the plays —the quotes— always appear in the report.

The assist sums it up: it doesn't go to the player who scores, and it's just as much a contribution. That's exactly what the report looks for.

WHEN THEY CONTRADICT EACH OTHER, THE NUMBERS WIN

Before the report is finalized, the two layers are cross-checked. If the interpretation says "great coordinator" but the numbers show that person almost never built on what others said, the level goes down. The numbers win because they're the most reliable data. Ana is a made-up name, like every name in this guide.

02 WHAT GOES IN AND WHAT COMES OUT

One input, *one report.*

What goes in

- **The session transcript.** The game has no built-in chat or voice: the whole conversation happens on the video call, and that's what gets transcribed. Text only: the analysis doesn't see the camera, hear tone of voice, or observe gestures.
- **The official participant list,** confirmed by the facilitator before the analysis: who played and who facilitated. Anyone not on the list isn't evaluated; anyone on it is included in the analysis. What they get in the report depends on the evidence they generated (section 07).
- **The count of speaking turns,** done mechanically on the transcript before the analysis.

What comes out

A report with **nine fixed sections**, always in the same order, in three formats: web version via link, PDF, and Excel. Section 10 explains what's in each one.

Web link

To read on screen and share.

PDF

To save, print, or attach.

Excel

With participation and level data, ready to work with.

03 LAYER 1 · WHAT GETS COUNTED

The six *metrics.*

They're calculated only for the people on the official list who played. The facilitator, observers, and anyone who appears in the transcript without being on the list are left out of every number.

1 Participation
How many times each person spoke and what percentage of the total that represents. Percentages always add up to 100.

2 Turn equity · Gini
A number from 0 to 1 that shows how evenly the conversation was shared.

3 Questions vs. statements
An inquiring or asserting style. Neither is good or bad: the team needs both.

4 Proposing vs. executing
Whether the person brings structure ("let's do it this way") or executes ("I'm chopping").

5 Uptake · highest weight
How many times they built on something someone else had just said. It's the countable way to measure listening, and the metric that carries the most weight when the layers are cross-checked.

6 Centrality
Their place in the "who responds to whom" network: how many people they responded to and how many responded to them.

How to read the Gini

Up to 0.20	0.21 to 0.35	0.36 to 0.50	Over 0.50
Very even	**Even**	**Moderately concentrated**	**Concentrated**
Everyone spoke about the same amount.	There are differences, but nobody was left out.	Two or three people carry the conversation.	One or two people dominate.

The formula, so you can recalculate it by hand

The Gini is calculated on the speaking turns of the evaluable people, in its population form, with no sample correction. Where x_i is each person's turns, n is the number of people, and $\bar{x}$ is the average number of turns:

$$G = \Sigma_i \Sigma_j |x_i - x_j| / (2 n^2 \bar{x})$$

Sorting the turns from lowest to highest, the same calculation is faster this way:

$$G = (2 \Sigma_i i \cdot x_i) / (n \cdot \Sigma_i x_i) - (n + 1)/n$$

WORKED EXAMPLE

Five people with 60, 44, 36, 30, and 30 turns. Total: 200 turns (30%, 22%, 18%, 15%, and 15%).

Sorted (30, 30, 36, 44, 60): 1×30 + 2×30 + 3×36 + 4×44 + 5×60 = 674.

$$G = (2 \times 674)/(5 \times 200) - 1 = 1.348 - 1.2 = 0.148$$

Reported as **0.15**: "very even." With the report's participation table, any reader can repeat this calculation.

WHEN IT ISN'T COUNTED

If the transcript has fewer than eight speaking turns in total, the report says "count not reliable due to insufficient volume" instead of producing a number. An honest gap is worth more than a false data point.



Inteligencia Colectiva del equipo

Distribución de participación:

Participante	Turnos de habla	% del grupo
Paula Arteaga	232	29%
Rodrigo Lemos	200	25%
Camila Nieva	176	22%
Ignacio Berti	120	15%
Sofía Quiroga	72	9%
TOTAL	**800**	**100%**

Equidad de turnos (Gini): 0.20 — **muy equitativa**. El reparto es razonablemente distribuido entre cuatro participantes; Sofía Quiroga queda por debajo del quinto esperado, lo que inclina levemente la distribución sin llegar a concentración dominante.

Densidad de coordinación: Tasa de uptake grupal alta: se identificaron más de 70 turnos con retoma explícita de lo dicho por otro (tasa grupal estimada ~0.09 sobre el total de turnos, con picos marcados en pre-partida y debrief). Nodos más centrales por grado de entrada: Paula Arteaga (retomada por los cuatro compañeros) y Rodrigo Lemos (retomado por Paula, Camila e Ignacio). La red es distribuida, sin un único hub dominante; los arcos fluyen en múltiples direcciones entre los cuatro participantes más activos.

Fortalezas del grupo como sistema:

- **Escucha mutua sostenida:** el equipo construyó sobre las ideas de los demás de forma recurrente a lo largo de las tres partidas; las propuestas de una persona eran retomadas y ampliadas por otra sin necesidad de insistencia.
- **Aprendizaje iterativo visible:** entre la primera y la tercera partida el equipo incorporó ajustes concretos (cortar en simultáneo para los pedidos triples, liberar el centro antes de

Figure 1. The "Collective intelligence" section of a demo report: participation table, Gini index, and team reading. The data is a fictional example and the people shown are made up.

04 LAYER 2 · WHAT GETS INTERPRETED

The six *competencies.*

They aren't personality traits. **They're functions a team needs someone to perform,** and the report observes who performed them in this session.

COMPETENCY	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE GAME	WHEN IT'S OBSERVED
1. Leadership	Giving the team a plan, roles, and priorities, and getting others to adopt them.	*"Let's split up: two on each side, you take the orders"*, and the rest answer "got it."	Before each round
2. Coordination & communication	Asking, confirming, and closing the loop so information arrives on time.	*"Do you have the lettuce?" "Yes, passing it over." "Got it."*	During the round
3. Team support	Covering for or helping a swamped teammate without being asked.	*"You look slammed, I'll take the window."*	During the round
4. Adaptability	Reorganizing quickly when something breaks.	*"OK, switch: you put out the fire, I'll keep going on the order."*	At every disruption
5. Climate & cohesion	Recognizing, encouraging, and easing tension when it shows up.	*"Nice one." "Relax, we'll nail the next one."*	Before the round, at peak pressure, and in the debrief
6. Reflection & learning	Naming what happened, why, and what they'd do differently.	*"We got stuck because nobody was taking the orders; next time, one person does only that."*	Only in the debrief

READING MISTAKES THE MODEL AVOIDS

Talking a lot isn't leading.

Giving an order isn't coordinating if nobody confirms it.

Doing your own task well isn't supporting the team.

Following a new order isn't adapting.

Being friendly at the start isn't sustaining the climate.

Talking in the debrief isn't reflecting.

Adaptability is only observable if there were disruptions (fires, side switches). Reflection, only if there was a debrief. If they were missing, the report marks them as "not observable" and doesn't penalize anyone.

05 HOW IT'S SCORED

10-MINUTE PATH

Five levels, *not fine-grained scores.*

Each competency is placed in one of five levels, each with a reference description. The number shown in the report is the center of that level's band, with its margin.

5	**Process leader** 92 ± 8	Sustained that process for the whole team, repeatedly and under pressure.	
4	**Strong contribution** 75 ± 10	Contributed clearly and on several occasions.	
3	**Functional contribution** 55 ± 10	Contributed what was needed: delivered without standing out.	
2	**Emerging contribution** 35 ± 10	There were signals, but few or not sustained.	
1	**Not observed / absent** 12 ± 12	Not seen in this session, or there was evidence against it.	

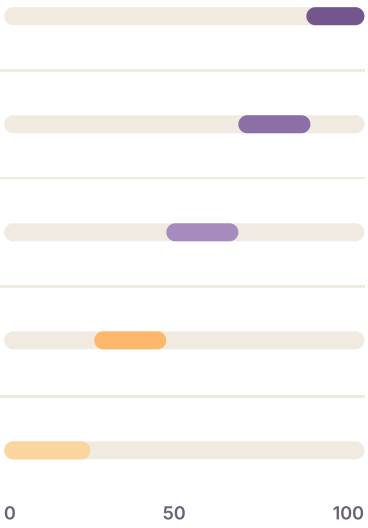


Figure 2. The five-level scale with its bands on a 0 to 100 scale.

Why five levels. Choosing among five categories with reference examples is far more reproducible than choosing a number between 0 and 100. Two readings of the same evidence almost always land in the same category or an adjacent one, never two apart. Hence the "±": within a category there's no finer precision to report.

THE MOST IMPORTANT READING RULE

A one-level difference between two people is within the instrument's margin. *It doesn't mean one is better than the other.*

If Ana has 75 in Coordination and Juan has 55, the conclusion isn't that Ana coordinates "better": it's that in this session she was seen coordinating more often. The quotes show how.

06 RULES

The rules that make it *reliable.*

These are the conditions the analysis must meet before stating anything about a person. They're the difference between disciplined observation and an opinion.

1 Only what was said counts
Nothing is ever inferred from the camera, tone, age, gender, accent, name, or job title.

2 At least two quotes per competency
A single statement isn't enough to assign a level.

3 No evidence, no claim
"Not observed" is a valid answer. It doesn't mean "can't do it."

4 Talking a lot doesn't earn points
You can dominate the conversation and still score low on Coordination if you never closed a loop.

5 Doing beats claiming
"I always organize everything" isn't Leadership. Assigning roles and having the team adopt them is.

6 Pressure counts more
What someone does at the peak of a round reveals more than what they say in the opening introductions.

7 Not every moment weighs the same
The pre-round talk and the debrief weigh more than the round itself; introductions, much less.

8 Numbers and interpretation must match
If a level contradicts the counted metrics, it's adjusted downward.

9 Rank never earns points
If someone leads "because they're the boss," the report flags it.

10 Signals, not verdicts
It says "shows signals consistent with," never "qualifies for" or "fit / not fit."

PRE-DELIVERY AUDIT

Before it's issued, every report goes through final checks. **If any check fails, the report isn't issued.**

- Everyone on the list is included
- The participant count matches
- Every level has its quotes
- Percentages add up to 100
- The language is the one requested
- No labeling language
- All sections are present

07 PROFILES

Who gets a *full profile.*

Not everyone present generates enough evidence for a profile. Instead of stretching the evidence, the analysis classifies each participant using countable thresholds.

A Full profile

Took part enough, with evidence across several competencies.

Metrics, the six competencies with their level, standout contributions, and quotes.

B Insufficient evidence

Spoke little, joined late, had technical issues, or acted as a facilitator.

A profile without scores, with the reason explained. Counts in the group's numbers.

C Only introduced themselves

Took part in the introductions and didn't speak again.

Doesn't appear in the report; at most, a footnote mention.

CATEGORY B IS NOT A BAD GRADE

It's always communicated as “requires a second observation”: the report would rather say nothing than make something up, and another opportunity is needed to see that person.

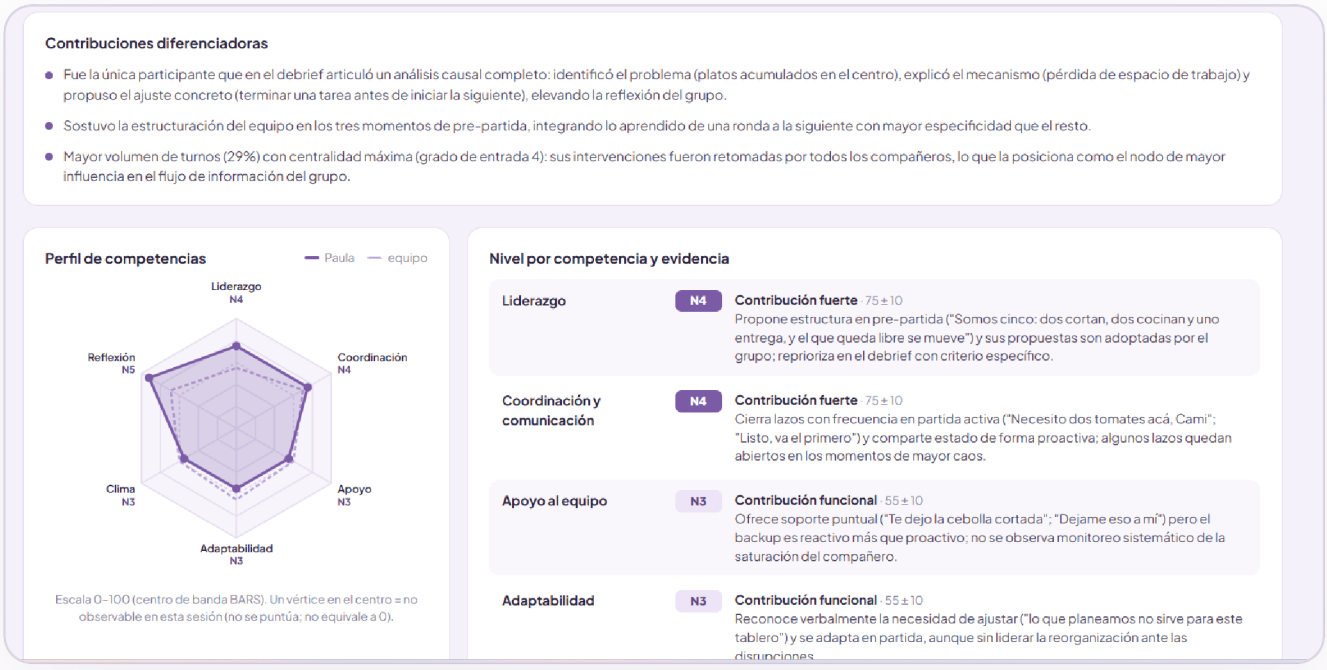


Figure 3. Individual profile from a demo report: competency radar and the level of each competency with the quotes that support it. The data is a fictional example and the people shown are made up.

08 FOUNDATIONS

Where the model *comes from.*

The model wasn't invented from scratch. Each piece rests on published research on teamwork. These are the three core sources and what each one contributes.

Bales, 1950 Interaction process analysis	Showed that a group's behavior can be broken down into concrete acts — proposing, asking, agreeing, objecting— and counted. It's the basis of Layer 1: count before you interpret.
Woolley and colleagues, 2010 Collective intelligence	Found that groups where speaking time is more evenly shared perform better as a team, regardless of each member's individual ability. It's why the report measures turn equity with the Gini.
Marks, Mathieu, and Zaccaro, 2001 Taxonomy of team processes	Organized what a team does into three families: planning and setting roles, coordinating and backing each other up during action, and managing the climate. The six Layer 2 competencies come from that map.

The five-level scale follows the logic of behaviorally anchored rating scales: each level is defined by observable behaviors, not by an adjective. Reflection draws on Kolb's experiential learning cycle, limited to the debrief.

09 THE PROCESS

How the analysis *is produced.*

IS THIS DONE BY AI?

Yes. The analysis is run by a language model *operating under a documented instruction protocol.*

The protocol is the manual the model follows: it defines the two layers, the counting rules, the anchors for each level, the evidence discipline, and the exact report format. It's the equivalent of the observation guide that human assessors receive in an assessment center.

- **Turns are counted before the model steps in.** Each person's speaking turns are counted mechanically on the transcript and reach the analysis already counted. Participation and the Gini are derived from those numbers by arithmetic: they don't depend on the model's judgment.
- **Low temperature.** The model runs with a low variability setting so that two runs on the same transcript produce consistent results.
- **Rules, not free judgment.** Every label and classification is derived from counts and levels, never “eyeballed.” And every level requires quotes that anyone can verify in the transcript.
- **Human validation.** The facilitator with an active license was in the session and can check each quote against what they saw.

10 READING

10-MINUTE PATH

How to read *the report.*

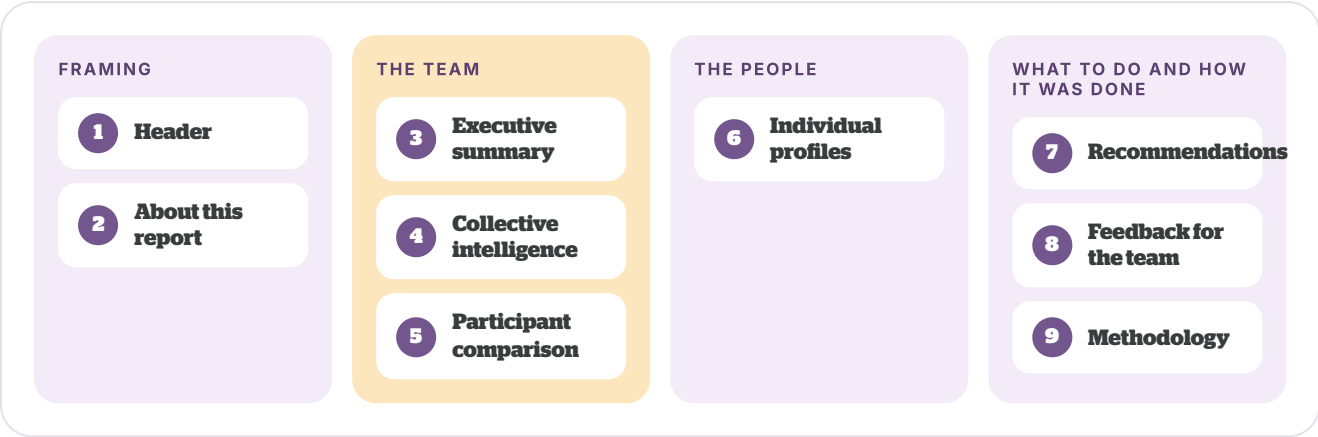


Figure 4. Map of the report's nine sections, grouped by what they're for.

SECTION	WHAT YOU'LL FIND	WHY LOOK AT IT
1. Header	Session details and how many participants have a full profile.	Confirm everyone is there.
2. About this report	What it is and what it isn't.	Frame the reading.
3. Executive summary	How the team worked, in four to six lines.	**If you read only one thing, read this.**
4. Collective intelligence	Participation, Gini, listening, and the group as a system.	Understand the team before the people.
5. Participant comparison	Everyone, ranked by observed level of contribution.	Big picture. It's not a merit ranking.
6. Individual profiles	Metrics, competencies, contributions, and quotes for each person.	To understand someone, start with the quotes.
7. Recommendations	Levers grounded in what was observed.	What to do with the results.
8. Feedback for the team	What they did well and what they can work on, without scores.	Share it with the participants.
9. Methodology	How it was generated and what its limits are.	Answer “where does this come from?”

A READING TIP

Team first (section 4), *then the people (section 6).*

Individual profiles only make sense within the system: an uptake of 3 doesn't mean the same thing in a team that listened a lot as in one where nobody listened.

11 USES

What it's *used for.*

There's only one measurement. The same report serves as input for different talent decisions:

Development	What each person contributed to the team and what they can work on, with concrete evidence.
Team dynamics	How speaking time was shared, how people coordinated, and where tensions showed up.
Succession	Who sustained key team processes under pressure.
Project staffing	What contributions each person can bring to a new team.
Hiring processes	What signals each participant showed and what's worth validating in the interview.

NEVER THE SOLE CRITERION

In any of these uses, the report is combined with interviews, day-to-day observation, and other tools. **No decision about a person should rest on it alone.**

12 LIMITS

10-MINUTE PATH

What it isn't *and how not to use it.*

It isn't a psychometric test	Nor a formal assessment center. It has no population norms or demonstrated predictive validity. It's a structured observation, and every report says so.
It doesn't measure traits or predict the future	It measures contributions in one session. Another session, with other people or different pressure, may paint a different picture.
It doesn't compare across sessions	Levels are relative to the group and the moment: a 75 on one team isn't comparable to a 75 on another.
It doesn't see nonverbal behavior	Someone who contributes a lot without speaking may be underestimated.
It doesn't decide	It should never be the sole criterion for hiring, promoting, or letting someone go.

THE HUMAN VALIDATION LAYER

The facilitator with an active license was present in the session. They can check each quote against what they saw and correct the reading of someone who contributed a lot without speaking. No automated analysis replaces that perspective.

13 FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

What people *ask us most.*

Why does someone who talked a lot have middling levels?

Because talking isn't contributing. If they didn't propose structure, didn't close loops, and didn't build on what others said, the report reflects that.

Why doesn't it say "fit / not fit"?

Because it informs; it doesn't decide. It shows what signals each person displayed and what to validate in the next step. The decision belongs to whoever makes it, with all the information available.

Why does almost everyone score 55 in Climate & cohesion?

Because the climate was good and stable and nobody did anything specific to improve it: that's a "functional contribution." To get a 4 or a 5, someone has to recognize others, encourage at peak pressure, or defuse a tension.

Why do the quotes appear in the original language?

Because they're reproduced exactly as they were said, even if the report is in another language. That's what makes them verifiable in the transcript.

What happens if there were no fires or debrief?

Adaptability and Reflection are marked "not observable" and aren't penalized, but the session yields less.

A report isn't a verdict. *It's the start of a conversation.*



QUESTIONS. If something in the report doesn't match what you saw in the session, raise it with the facilitator who ran the session: they were there. For questions about the methodology: consultas@teamcookgame.com

Legal notice. The Team Process Report is a structured observation of a single session: it complements, and does not replace, interviews, performance evaluations, or validated psychometric instruments. It should not be used as the sole criterion in decisions about people. The examples, names, and figures in this guide are fictional.